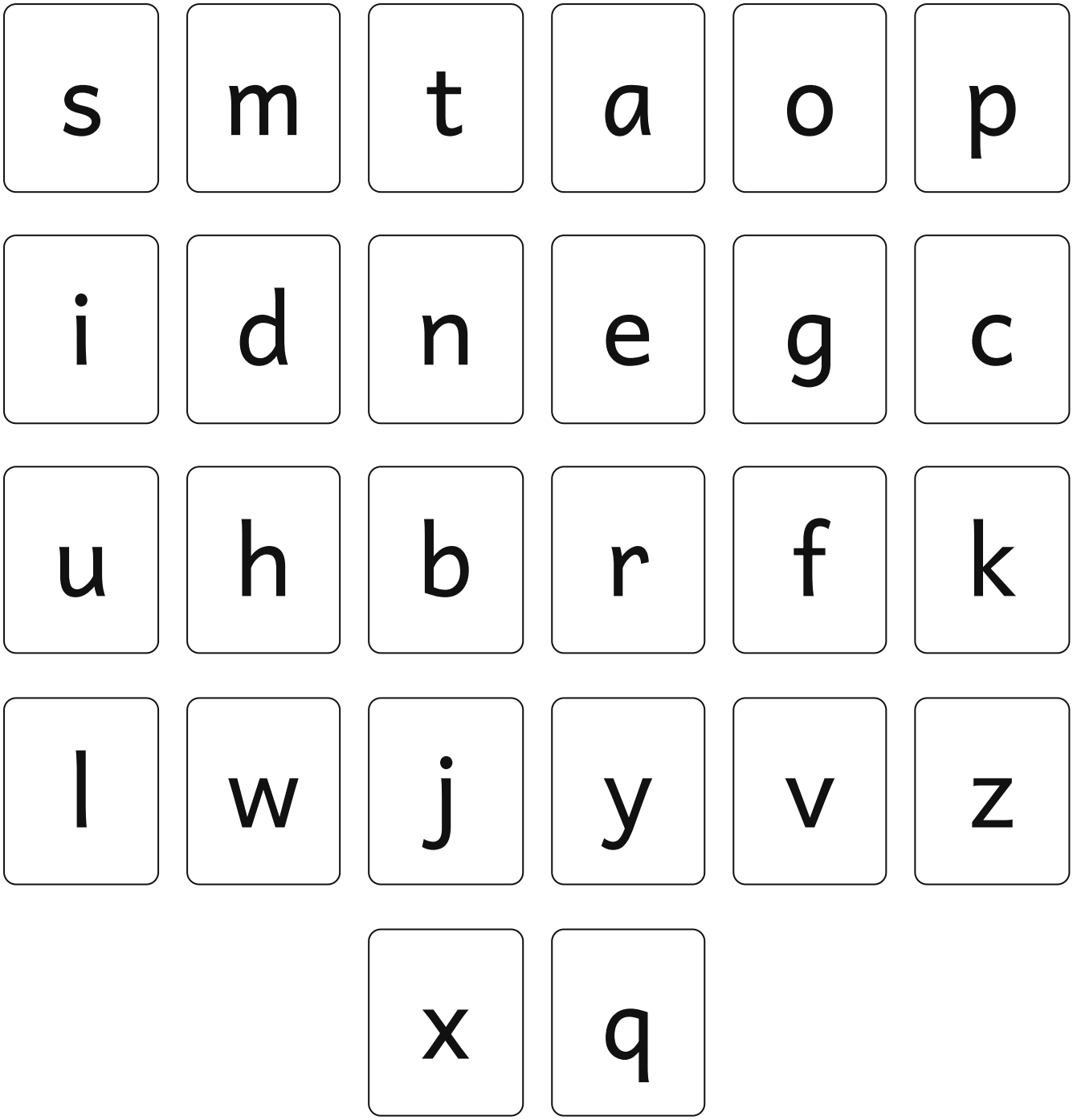
Early Reading Screen: Reading cards

For the assessor. Do not show this page to the child.

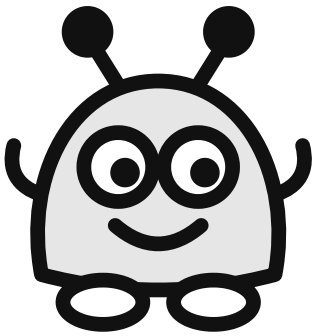
The child reads from these cards, one to one. The scripts and scoring rules are in the **instructions** (`Early_Reading_Screen_Guide`); the **record sheets** (`Early_Reading_Screen_Record`) are printed once for each child.

- Print once, single-sided, and keep each card in a plastic sleeve. Colour and greyscale both work.
- Put only the card you are using in front of the child. Keep the record sheets out of sight.
- Do not read the cards aloud. The only words you say from a card are the practice words on Card 3 and the title of each passage, as the script says.
- On Cards 3 to 7 the creature marks a **creature name** (a nonsense word). The small grey numbers on the word cards match the record sheet.
- The passages get harder from Card 9 to Card 16. The child reads only the two or three passages the start rules choose.

Card	Page	Part	What is on it
1	2	Letter sounds	26 single letters
2	3	Letter sounds	18 letter groups (sh, ai, igh ...)
3	4	Phonics words	Practice: one real word and one creature name
4	5	Phonics words, Section 1	Words 1 to 10
5	6	Phonics words, Section 1	Words 11 to 20
6	7	Phonics words, Section 2	Words 21 to 30
7	8	Phonics words, Section 2	Words 31 to 40
8	9	Tricky words	20 common exception words
9	10	Passages	Passage 1: Where Is the Cat? (Pink, Oxford Level 1+, 23 words)
10	11	Passages	Passage 2: At the Market (Red, Oxford Level 2, 36 words)
11	12	Passages	Passage 3: The Kite (Yellow, Oxford Level 3, 57 words)
12	13	Passages	Passage 4: A New Friend (Light Blue, Oxford Level 4, 79 words)
13	14	Passages	Passage 5: The Lucky Dumpling (Green, Oxford Level 5, 99 words)
14	15	Passages	Passage 6: The Fast Train (Orange, Oxford Level 6, 126 words)
15	16	Passages	Passage 7: The Rabbit Lantern (Turquoise and Purple, Oxford Level 7 to 8, 151 words)
16	17	Passages	Passage 8: The Drummer (Gold and White, Oxford Level 9 to 10, 178 words)


s m t a o p
i d n e g c
u h b r f k
l w j y v z
x q

sh	ee	ch	ai	th	oo
ar	ck	oa	ng	or	igh
qu	ow	ur	oi	ear	air



hat



jop

1

map

2



dop

3

leg

4



mub

5

sit

6



pem

7

shop

8



chig

9

duck

10



thep

11

frog

12



blom

13

jump

14



nesk

15

bring

16



trab

17

think

18



chulp

19

stamp

20



glust

21

rain

22



jeek

23

night

24



toap

25

moon

26



darp

27

turn

28



sorp

29

down

30



choil

31

cake

32



jeme

33

smile

34



plome

35

tube

36



flape

37

garden

38



lompid

39

picnic

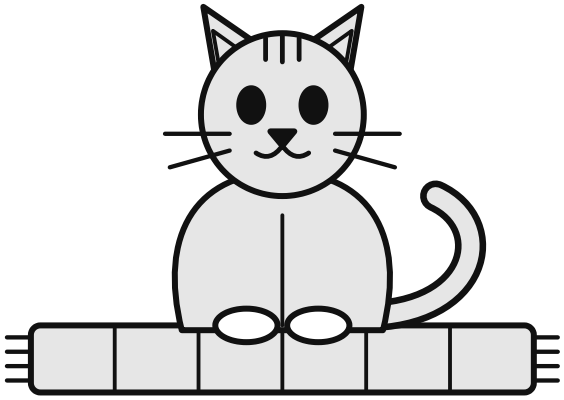
40



shoomit

1 the	2 was	3 you	4 said
5 they	6 are	7 come	8 one
9 where	10 friend	11 door	12 find
13 could	14 water	15 many	16 again
17 half	18 people	19 busy	20 because

Where Is the Cat?



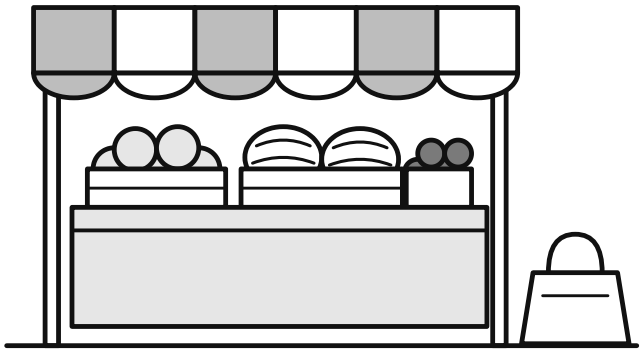
The cat is on the mat.

The cat is on the bed.

The cat is in the box.

The cat is on Dad!

At the Market



Mei and Gran go to the market.

Gran gets a fish.

Gran gets six eggs.

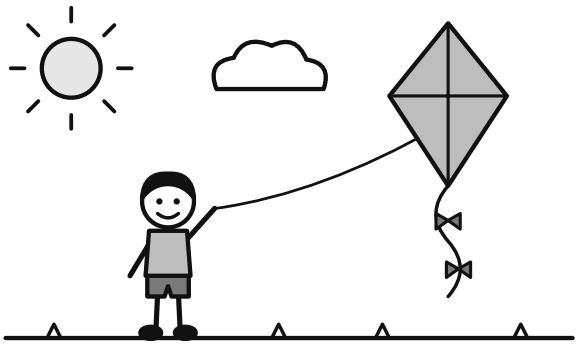
Gran gets a big melon.

The bag is full.

"I can help," said Mei.

Mei and Gran get on the bus.

The Kite



Tom and Dad went to the park.

They had a big green kite.

The wind was strong.

Up, up, up went the kite!

Then it got stuck in a tree.

"Oh no!" said Tom.

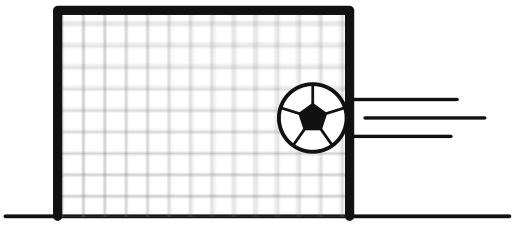
Dad got a long stick.

He got the kite down.

"Thank you, Dad!" said Tom.

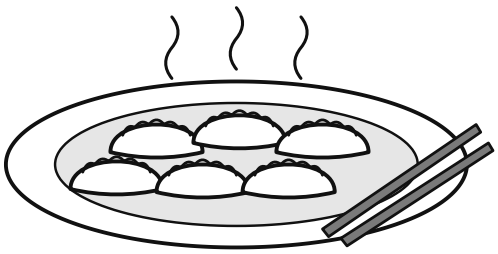
Soon the kite was up in the sky.

A New Friend



It was Monday morning.
A new girl came to Hao's class.
Her name was Sofia.
She sat next to Hao.
She did not say a word.
"Do you want to play?" asked Hao.
Sofia looked at the floor.
At playtime, they went outside.
Hao kicked a ball to Sofia.
Sofia kicked it back, hard!
The ball shot past Hao into the net.
"Goal!" shouted Hao. Sofia smiled.
"Can we play again?" she said.
They played until the bell rang.

The Lucky Dumpling



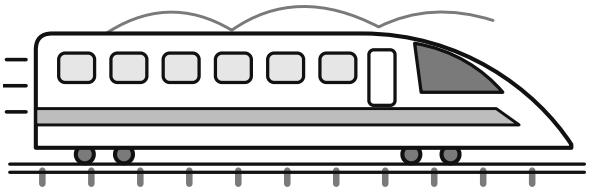
It was the day before Spring Festival. Lin and Grandma were making dumplings in the kitchen. Grandma hid a coin inside one of the dumplings. "The person who finds the coin will be lucky all year," she said.

That evening, the whole family sat down to eat. Lin ate one dumpling, then two, then three. There was no coin. Lin was too full to eat any more.

Dad found nothing. Mum found nothing. Then Grandpa bit into a dumpling and stopped. He smiled and held up the shiny coin.

"Grandpa is the lucky one!" shouted Lin, and everyone laughed.

The Fast Train



Amir and his mum were going to visit his cousins in Shanghai. At the station, the fast train was waiting. It was long and white, with a pointed nose like a bird.

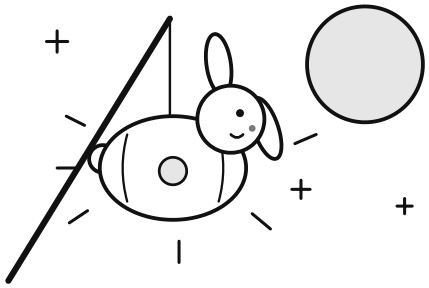
Amir found his seat next to a big window. At first, the train moved slowly. Then it went faster and faster. Green fields, rivers and tall buildings rushed past.

"This train is even faster than our car!" said Amir.

After a while, a lady pushed a trolley along the carriage. Mum bought two bowls of noodles and a bottle of water. Amir ate his noodles and looked out of the window. Soon his eyes began to close.

When he woke up, the train had stopped. "Wake up, sleepy head," said Mum. "We are here!"

The Rabbit Lantern



Every year, Chen Yu's class made paper lanterns for the Mid-Autumn Festival. This year, Miss Wang showed them how to make a rabbit.

Chen Yu cut out two long ears and glued them on carefully. But when he held up his lantern, one ear flopped down. The rabbit's face was crooked, too. Next to him, Aisha had made a perfect rabbit with neat pink eyes.

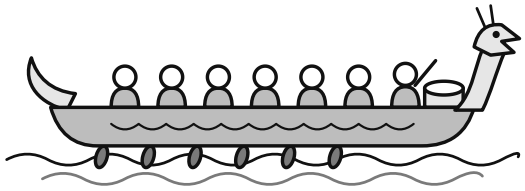
"Mine looks silly," Chen Yu said quietly.

That evening, his family walked to the park by the lake. The full moon was round and bright, and hundreds of lanterns glowed in the dark. Grandpa put a small light inside the rabbit, and it began to shine.

A little girl pulled her mother's sleeve. "Look at that rabbit!" she said. "It is waving its ear at me!"

Chen Yu looked at his lantern again. Then he smiled, lifted it high and made the floppy ear wave hello.

The Drummer



Zhang Wei had never felt so nervous. It was the Dragon Boat Festival, and his school was racing three other boats on the lake. Twelve children sat in two long rows, holding their paddles. At the front sat the drummer, and this year the drummer was Zhang Wei.

"Remember," said Coach Liu, "the paddlers listen to your drum. Keep a steady beat, and they will paddle together."

The whistle blew, and the boats shot forward. Zhang Wei was so excited that he beat the drum far too fast. Behind him, the paddles splashed in a muddle, and the boat began to wobble. Another boat slid past them.

Zhang Wei took a deep breath. He thought of the clock in his classroom, ticking slowly and evenly. Boom, boom, boom. One by one, the paddlers found the beat, and the boat flew across the water like an arrow.

They did not win, but they came a close second. Afterwards, Coach Liu shook Zhang Wei's hand. "A good drummer does not just make a noise," she said. "A good drummer listens."